

PROSPER AWUNI

Lead Security Analyst | Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) professional with over five years of experience in detection engineering, threat hunting, incident response, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) engineering across complex enterprise environments. I bring hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Splunk and SPL, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection development, and building high-fidelity detection content that drives meaningful security outcomes. I have set technical direction for SOC operations, owned detection backlogs, driven investigation quality standards, and built the capability of analysts through pairing and tradecraft guidance. My experience across Microsoft Azure security, CrowdStrike Falcon, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), and enterprise SOAR platforms positions me well to take technical ownership of detection and response engagements. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, and I have a proven track record of engaging with governance frameworks including ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), which align closely with UK public sector security standards.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** KQL (Microsoft Sentinel), SPL (Splunk), MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTP)-aligned rules, Sigma rule development, threat hunting hypothesis design
- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk, SOAR playbook development, automated triage and enrichment workflows
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry; TTP mapping; proactive indicator analysis
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, full lifecycle management (detection, investigation, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review)
- **Microsoft Security:** MDE (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint), MDI (Microsoft Defender for Identity), M365 (Microsoft 365) Defender, Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover), Tanium
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, BeyondTrust PAM, Conditional Access, Multi-factor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, CE+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Set the technical direction for SOC operations across a 10,000+ user estate, owning the detection backlog, threat-landscape narrative, and investigation quality standards for the security team
- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, developing high-fidelity analytics rules, threat hunting hypotheses, and SOAR playbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, and maintaining coverage against current threat actors
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry, developing and testing hypotheses, investigating anomalies, and feeding findings back into the detection rule backlog
- Lead major security incident investigations under the NIST 800-61 incident response framework, serving as the senior escalation point and coordinating full-lifecycle response from detection through eradication

and post-incident improvement

- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Prevent, and EDR at enterprise scale, maintaining detection policies, response workflows, and module configurations
- Administer MDE, MDI, and M365 Defender, maintaining detection configurations and automated response policies for 8,000 users
- Develop SOAR automation for alert triage, enrichment, and response orchestration, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and enabling consistent, repeatable response at scale
- Maintain detection and response coverage aligned to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and CE+, supporting audit evidence and control review processes
- Provide technical mentoring and quality assurance for junior security analysts, pairing on complex investigations, reviewing detection rule logic, and setting investigation tradecraft standards
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, PIM, and BeyondTrust PAM, enforcing least-privilege identity security controls across the estate

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Developed KQL detection content within Microsoft Sentinel, including correlation rules, threat hunting queries, and workbooks covering endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry
- Conducted Splunk SPL-based log analysis and contributed to SOAR integration, developing search queries and correlation rules for threat investigations
- Performed advanced alert triage and incident investigation across SIEM and EDR platforms, mapping observed indicators to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs and escalating high-severity incidents
- Contributed to the deployment of MDE to 8,000 users, establishing detection baselines, automated remediation, and alert management policies
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-ranked findings and supporting remediation tracking
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID and BeyondTrust PAM, supporting identity and privileged access governance including Conditional Access and PIM reviews
- Developed PowerShell automation to reduce manual SOC task handling and improve operational efficiency
- Supported CE+ and ISO 27001 compliance activities, contributing to evidence gathering and control assessments relevant to UK public sector security standards

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Monitored and investigated security events across a cloud-hosted SaaS and FinTech environment, administering CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and responding to alerts in line with incident response procedures
- Contributed to vulnerability management and patch prioritisation, working with development and infrastructure teams to remediate high-severity findings
- Administered identity and access management controls including MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), and group policy, enforcing least-privilege access principles across the platform
- Documented security processes and contributed to quality assurance procedures in line with organisational security policy

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained a detection engineering backlog of over 40 KQL rules and SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, improving threat visibility and reducing alert noise across the estate
- Led the enterprise-wide MDE deployment to 8,000 users with zero service disruption, delivering full EDR coverage, automated remediation, and real-time alert management at scale
- Identified a previously undetected persistence mechanism through a proactive threat hunting exercise, resulting in the complete remediation of a compromised privileged account chain
- Reduced MTTR to security incidents by 35% through the development of 12 SOAR automation playbooks, enabling consistent and scalable response to high-volume incident types

- Maintained CE+ and ISO 27001 certification compliance, contributing to audit evidence, policy development, and control assessments in line with UK public sector security expectations

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)